



TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

Ethiopia: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-25

Edition of 2026-08-25-2 · 96 systems and instruments tracked, 5 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-25 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections follow the status report. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.

Of 96 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 67 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-25, 12 did not, 12 carry no stated baseline, and 5 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 196 sources for this place in the window — 45 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 151 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

Two positions changed maturity. The Horizon Fiber corridor **advanced**, from a December 2024 memorandum to a [binding agreement in February 2026](#) linking Djibouti's subsea landings through Ethiopia to Sudan's. Donor-funded health and surveillance data systems **regressed**, with [livestock and zoonotic surveillance suspended](#) after the 2025 United States aid freeze, though the national health information system stayed online on local staffing.

Ethiopia's foundational layers — the identity, the payments rails, the health information system, the strategy — were already in place when the window opened and did not change maturity band. What the year added was reach, compulsion and commercialisation on top of them, and one binding regional agreement underneath.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Ethio Telecom network	Nationwide incumbent network (2025-08)	99.8% coverage (2026-04) on 90.1m subscribers; 215.8bn Birr revenue in FY2025/26 with data and internet 31.1% of it against mobile voice at 23.5%, operating profit 92.9bn Birr	ADVANCED, IN REACH AND REVENUE
Network expansion contracts from MWC 2026	Did not exist	Ericsson 1,500 sites and 502 upgrades under the MWC contracts; separately, 879 sites completed under the ZTE programme (462 RAN modernisation, 237 microwave-link upgrades, 103 IP RAN sites), 92% 4G population coverage across ZTE's own network footprint, with 124 new sites, 272 U2100 refarming sites and 115 rural sites still to come	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Next Horizon: Digital & Beyond 2028 strategy	Did not exist	A three-year corporate strategy to 2028 carrying six strategic themes, nineteen strategic objectives, four strategic-priority categories and a three-year indicator table, published by the operator on its own site	ADVANCED
Safaricom Ethiopia second network	10.06m 90-day active customers (2025-06)	14.7m 90-day active customers; the development financiers diluted to 9.5% and 6.81% with a right to reacquire; more than 67 existing sites upgraded across nine Southern Region towns against congestion and power-supply problems	ADVANCED
Safaricom regional fibre deployment	Did not exist	Under construction, Afdera to Mekelle	ADVANCED
teleStream and Zero-Touch Broadband	Did not exist	Live	ADVANCED

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Wingu Cloud Exchange in-country cloud	Did not exist	Compute, Kubernetes and storage priced in birr, hybrid with Azure and AWS	ADVANCED
Data-centre estate	BASELINE NOT HELD	Named among the markets diversifying Africa's estate, against South Africa's 60%+ share (2026-07)	Baseline not held

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Bitdeer Oromia bitcoin-mining site	Did not exist	40 MW operating with 20 MW in progress	ADVANCED
Ethio Telecom Green Operator renewable network programme	27 MW installed solar at the FY2024/25 close, derived	39.72 MW installed solar across 190 fully solar-powered sites, 867 hybrid solar-and-battery systems and 1,114 lithium-ion storage units, with diesel generator running time down by up to 40%	ADVANCED

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
INSA cybersecurity and sovereign-cloud foundations	Did not exist	Sovereign cloud and forensic laboratory stated in the strategy, not built	ADVANCED

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Telecommunications Licensing Directive 792/2021	In force (2021-07)	In force; unified operator licences awarded by competitive bidding and valid fifteen years	NO CHANGE

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Telecom liberalisation	Two operators (2025-08)	Two operators; the argument has moved to whether the state is provider or regulator	NO CHANGE

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Horizon Fiber terrestrial corridor	Memorandum of intent (2024-12)	In active deployment: end-to-end solution architecture finalised and site-material procurement complete on a multi-terabit terrestrial corridor linking Djibouti, Ethiopia, Sudan and Jeddah	ADVANCED

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Universal Access Fund levy	Did not exist	About 2.5bn birr a year from Ethio Telecom and Safaricom	ADVANCED

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Smartphone affordability financing	Did not exist	Up to two million handsets a year on long-term instalments	ADVANCED

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Ethio Telecom and Huawei enterprise stack	Did not exist	Scoping only; no value or term disclosed	ADVANCED
Inspur and Shandong data-centre track	Did not exist	Planned; no site or value stated	ADVANCED

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
RailTel data-centre build	Did not exist	Planned	ADVANCED

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Licensing framework for LEO satellite operators	In force (2021-07)	Satellite services licensable as a GMPCS landing-right class authorisation; no LEO operator authorised on record	NO CHANGE

Horizon Fiber moved from planned to under way: the memorandum signed by Ethio Telecom, Djibouti Telecom and Sudatel in December 2024 became binding in February 2026. It is the only position in this section that improved.

The network itself held position throughout — implemented at the window's start and implemented now, with the year's news being scale and contracts rather than maturity: [99.8% coverage, expansion deals at Mobile World Congress for 1,500 and 647 sites](#). The market structure also held: two operators, a third-operator round launched in 2023 and paused, and no LEO licensing framework after the regulator's flat denial in July 2025.

What arrived is foreign compute: a bitcoin-mining site on cheap power, an in-country cloud exchange, an Indian data-centre work order, scoping talks with a Chinese vendor — plus a [universal-access levy of 1.5% of operator revenue](#).

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National data exchange platform	Did not exist	Approved and paired with a predictive model; not built	ADVANCED
EthSwitch national switch	BASELINE NOT HELD	Links M-PESA to more than 30 banks and wallets; EthQR across 50,000+ merchants	Baseline not held

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Biometric enrolment kits for banks	Did not exist	2,000 of 6,000 planned distributed, about US\$17m, with 4,000 re-tendered	ADVANCED
Ethio Telecom as identity enrolment channel	Enrolling since 2024-04	About 32m citizens enrolled, 20.19m in FY2025/26; custody and consent terms not stated	ADVANCED
Fayda national digital identity	16.4m registrations (2025-06)	49.1m enrolments on 12,000 registration kits deployed; 194m eKYC verifications to date across 150 integrated agencies	ADVANCED
Faydaverse digital public infrastructure enterprise	Did not exist	State-owned enterprise under Ethiopian Investment Holdings, with over 190m authentications performed and 150 enterprises integrated for biometric checks	ADVANCED
Safaricom and Africom identity registration joint venture	Did not exist	Covering Afar, Amhara, Tigray, Sidama and three southern regions	ADVANCED
Faydaverse digital identity wallet	Not held	Planned to carry academic transcripts, professional licences, healthcare records, property titles and financial-compliance and know-your-customer data beyond the core government credentials it holds today; the enterprise says it is also exporting digital-identity services as an implementation partner in Mozambique and Zambia	BASELINE NOT HELD
Super Agent registration procurement	BASELINE NOT HELD	A four-lot procurement of about US\$54m for registration super agents, with evaluation complete and the award awaiting the lender's no-objection	Baseline not held

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital transactions at the dominant state bank	No transaction series held for the bank	3.48 billion digital transactions worth more than 22 trillion birr in the 2025/26 fiscal year, put at about 70 per cent of the value of national digital financial transactions, with the bank moving its information-systems architecture to an AI-supported zero-trust model	ADVANCED
EthioPay national instant payment system	Did not exist	Account-to-account and wallet-to-wallet across 32 banks and 12 microfinance institutions	ADVANCED
EthSwitch and Mastercard international acceptance	Did not exist	International acceptance through EthSwitch	ADVANCED
M-PESA Ethiopia	Operating since 2023-08, before switch integration	2.58m monthly active users and 89,877 registered merchants (2026-06); about 2% of Safaricom Ethiopia's service revenue, against 45.6% in Kenya	ADVANCED, MARGINAL IN REVENUE
M-PESA Ethiopia cardless ATM withdrawals	Did not exist	Cardless ATM cash withdrawal live with Bank of Abyssinia, in-app authorisation and authentication before dispensing cash, processed in real time; integration set to expand to further banks	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
M-PESA LeHulum telco-agnostic wallet	Did not exist	Telco-agnostic wallet verified against the digital identity	ADVANCED
Mandatory Fayda integration with bank accounts	Directive issued (2025-12-10)	All bank accounts required to be harmonised with the digital identity	ADVANCED
Prepaid electricity purchase in the mobile wallet	Did not exist	Prepaid electricity bought in the wallet	ADVANCED
Regional tax payment through the mobile wallet	Did not exist	First of a planned series with regional revenue authorities	ADVANCED
Telebirr mobile money	Operating since 2021	60.6m users, 410,700 agents; about 11bn Birr a day	ADVANCED
Sybrin and Moti Engineering payments partnership	Not held	A South African financial-technology firm entered the Ethiopian payments market with a local engineering partner, aligning onboarding, fraud-management and workflow-automation tools with the National Digital Payments Strategy 2026-2030	BASELINE NOT HELD

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
America First Global Health Strategy memorandum of understanding	Did not exist	Planned United States support of US\$1,016,000,000 across 2026-2030 against Ethiopia's US\$450,000,000, of which US\$18,850,149 is for health data systems on a profile falling from US\$6,283,383 in 2026 to US\$1,256,677 in 2030, with Ethiopia to carry software licensing, cloud, hardware and maintenance costs for those systems; the United States reserves 6% of the top-line budget for its own management and operations, and Ethiopia signed through the Minister of Finance	ADVANCED
DHIS2 national health information system	National since 2018, 95%+ of facilities	95%+ of facilities, maturity 2.81 of 5 with ICT infrastructure weakest at 2.14, and functionality for calculating reports received against reports expected available in 75.0% of data offices assessed	ADVANCED
Donor-funded health and surveillance data systems	Donor-funded surveillance operating	Livestock and zoonotic surveillance suspended; the national health system stayed online on local staffing	REGRESSED
Livestock Information System	Did not exist	Five priority databases repositioned as a national asset register – the implementer's own account	ADVANCED
eCHIS community health information system	In use (2023-06)	Offline-first, constrained by 9% rural electricity and 4% 4G coverage	NO CHANGE
Unified Data System for HIV case management	BASELINE NOT HELD	In use by 950 community health workers, with data-access time reported down from a month to a day, 92% of mobile and 94% of web accounts actively used and data completeness near 100%	Baseline not held

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
MESOB unified public-service platform	41 services across 12 federal agencies (2025-07)	The platform's own public catalogue states 180+ government services from 23 named provider organisations, among them the public procurement authority, the transport ministry, the state commercial bank, the state telecommunications operator and the food and drug authority, each service listed with its required documents, processing time and fees. The far larger figure the base also holds is on a different basis and not a later one: a government communication of 20 April 2026 claims 2,260 services integrated into a single platform, two months before the 185 stated at the June 2026 launch, so the two counts run concurrently rather than showing a twelvefold rise. Services are onboarded ahead of the underlying systems, on two incompatible integration models	ADVANCED
Unmanned smart police station	Did not exist	Round-the-clock kiosks for reports, fines and documents	ADVANCED
Identity integration with tax administration	Integrated (2023-12)	Integrated	NO CHANGE
Electronic Government Procurement (e-GP) system	BASELINE NOT HELD	Credited by the Auditor General with the decline in cash shortages across 163 audited federal institutions; no Birr amount stated	Baseline not held

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National Digital Payments Strategy 2026-2030	Did not exist	Proposes the first outbound cross-border transfers, against 18.5tn birr a year	ADVANCED
Digital Government Strategy and Enterprise Architecture 2024-2029	In force (2024-07)	In force	NO CHANGE

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National Livestock Data Standards	Did not exist	Endorsed, with more than 300 experts and collectors trained	ADVANCED
Ethiopian eGovernment Interoperability Framework	In development (2024-07)	Still in development	NO CHANGE
MOSIP open-source identity platform	In use (2025-05)	The reference implementation the wider ecosystem points to	NO CHANGE

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Makatet refugee-inclusion framework	Did not exist	Covers 1.1m refugees and 2m internally displaced people	ADVANCED

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Identity mandate for school enrolment and examinations	Did not exist	Identity required for school enrolment and examinations	ADVANCED
Remote account opening on the digital identity	Did not exist	Account opening on the digital identity alone	ADVANCED

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
AI service bundles in the mobile-money app	Did not exist	Generative-AI bundles bought with M-PESA and redeemed by SMS voucher	ADVANCED

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital ID Assessment as official monitoring	First run (2025-01)	Adopted as the programme's official monitoring instrument and re-run	ADVANCED

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Addis Ababa one-stop digital service centres	BASELINE NOT HELD	11 one-stop centres carrying more than 150 services from more than 25 integrated institutions; no volumes, cost or evaluation published	Baseline not held

Nothing here changed maturity band. The identity system held position at both ends — implemented on 2025-08-01 and implemented now — while its [registrations rose from 16.4m in June 2025 to about 46.5m](#) by July 2026.

What arrived on top of it is compulsion and commercialisation: mandatory harmonisation of every bank account with the credential by March 2026, backed by biometric kits distributed to 31 banks; a school-enrolment and examination mandate; commercialisation into the sovereign wealth fund as authentication-as-a-service; a refugee-inclusion framework; and a registration joint venture covering seven regions. The identity assessment framework the programme adopted as its official monitoring instrument predates the window and held position through it.

Payments arrived in layers: an instant payment system, a telco-agnostic wallet, international card acceptance, a strategy proposing first-ever outbound cross-border transfers, and — in the window's final fortnight — utilities and regional tax collection inside the mobile-money app. The switch that makes all of it work carries no baseline the base can date.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Berne Convention accession	Did not exist	Draft ratification proclamation submitted to the Council of Ministers; Ethiopia not yet a party	ADVANCED
Copyright Proclamation 410/2004 online-infringement amendment	Did not exist	Draft would add internet service provider duties, procedures for blocking infringing sites and a rights-holder take-down notice to the 2004 proclamation	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Critical Infrastructure Cybersecurity Proclamation No. 1426/2026	Did not exist	12 critical sectors designated, 18 core obligations on owners and operators, and a Critical Infrastructure Cybersecurity Fund; art.28 sets a one-year transition to commencement after gazettelement (about July 2027); the Council of Ministers and INSA hold regulation-making powers under arts.26-27	ADVANCED
Judicial review of licence revocation without court order	Did not exist	December 2025 decree struck down; revocation without a court order held unconstitutional	ADVANCED
Prohibition of virtual assets	Did not exist	The whole category prohibited absent express authorisation; no new rule, no enforcement mechanism	ADVANCED
Tax assessment of payment gateways	Did not exist	Three-year throughput restated from ETB 32bn to 143.9bn and taxed; corrected data refused	ADVANCED, AS AN ENFORCEMENT ACTION RATHER THAN AS POLICY

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital Ethiopia 2030	Did not exist	Three pillars; targets of 128m subscriptions and an identity for every adult by 2030	ADVANCED
National Data Governance Strategy	Did not exist	In development; health the most fragmented sector, at 70+ siloed platforms	ADVANCED
National Artificial Intelligence Policy	In force (2024)	In force	NO CHANGE
National Digital Transformation Council	BASELINE NOT HELD	Holds that the programme is to be judged on lives changed, with no published measure behind it	Baseline not held

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital identity cooperation with Zambia	Did not exist	Identity cooperation agreed	ADVANCED
Digital public infrastructure export to Mozambique	Did not exist	Digital-ID, DPI-pilot, interoperability and cybersecurity support to Mozambique, with a joint working group	ADVANCED

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Data request to diplomatic missions	Did not exist	A foreign ministry note asking all accredited diplomatic missions and international and regional organisations to submit lists and addresses of every Ethiopian and foreign employee without diplomatic privileges, together with tenant and landlord details	ADVANCED
Data sharing arrangement under the health memorandum	Did not exist	The two governments intend to negotiate an arrangement for exchanging data on the memorandum's long-term performance and for accountability to the United States Congress, expected to run two years beyond the five-year term; a rights organisation's reading of the seven signed memoranda puts Ethiopia among five whose text requires unilateral sharing of specimens and pathogen-sequencing data, and all seven as requiring broad audit access. No text is published, and the State Department briefly posted a subset in March 2026, then removed access	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Development Bank of Ethiopia Information Disclosure Policy	Did not exist	In force: client credit information and other named categories are exempt from declassification where disclosure could cause substantial harm to the Bank, its stakeholders or national interest; the Bank may also decline requests requiring it to create records it does not already hold	ADVANCED
Personal Data Protection Proclamation 1321/2024	In force, no secondary directives (2025-08)	In force; directives still unissued and the Authority has yet to enforce	NO CHANGE

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
World Artificial Intelligence Cooperation Organization membership	Did not exist	One of 29 founding states; constitutive text, powers and binding force all unestablished	ADVANCED

Nothing here changed maturity either.

The data-protection law held the same position at both ends of the window: in force, with [secondary directives unissued and the regulator yet to enforce](#). That is a full year in which the instrument governing a credential used 4m times a day did not move, while the credential itself became compulsory for banking and schooling.

Everything else in the section arrived. The national digital strategy was launched in December 2025; a national data governance strategy entered development in March 2026, grounded in use cases and finding health the most fragmented sector with more than 70 siloed platforms; and the two payment instruments that close the year — the [virtual-asset prohibition](#) restated by notice, and the [gateway tax assessment](#) — both arrived in the window's final fortnight.

In June 2026 a court struck down licence revocation without a court order, on reasoning that suspicion does not constitute guilt, and flagged a regulator's conflict of interest in being both supervisor and market participant.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Ethiopian Artificial Intelligence Institute	Operating (2020)	Built MESOB and anchors the state's AI capability claim	NO CHANGE

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Vodacom change of control over Safaricom	Did not exist	Completed; the Ethiopian regulatory approval is not on the record	ADVANCED
Domestic engineering services firms	BASELINE NOT HELD	One named Addis Ababa engineering services firm, founded 2021 (2026-07)	Baseline not held

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Chinese AI model adoption	BASELINE NOT HELD	DeepSeek about 20% of chatbot use, the top of its 11-14% Africa range (2026-03)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
AI University Innovation Pod	Did not exist	Running with UNDP and Addis Ababa University	ADVANCED
Artificial Intelligence University construction	Did not exist	A single named capital project; no site or timetable published	ADVANCED

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Ethio Telecom public share offer	Offer closed (2025-02)	10% distributed through Telebirr	NO CHANGE

No maturity changed. The institutional base — an AI institute since 2020 and a national policy adopted in 2024 — held position throughout. What arrived was money and buildings: [an innovation pod in February 2026](#), and in the window's last month [an appropriation of ETB 5,000,000,000 for an AI university as a single named capital project](#). The appropriation is domestic revenue rather than donor or vendor finance. Two rows carry no baseline and both bear on dependency. [Chinese model adoption at about 20% of chatbot usage](#) cannot be dated at either end of the window, and neither can the domestic engineering-services layer. Nothing held measures the trend in either.

Inclusion and capacity

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Rural mobile-internet gender gap	BASELINE NOT HELD	81% in rural areas against 29% urban (2026-03)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Mobile connections and internet penetration	85.4m connections at 63.8% of population (early 2025)	93.2m connections at 68.4% (late 2025)	ADVANCED

One position worsened, and it came from outside the country. Donor-funded health and surveillance data systems regressed when the 2025 United States aid freeze suspended livestock and zoonotic surveillance. The national health information system stayed online on local staffing.

Neither headline measurement was re-taken inside the window: [mobile connections at 93.2m and 68.4% penetration](#) in late 2025, and a [rural mobile-internet gender gap of 81% against 29% urban](#). The universal-access levy that arrived in March 2026 is the only instrument aimed directly at that gap, and no outcome from it is on record.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digitally enabled pluralistic extension services programme (FAO)	Did not exist	US\$300,000 FAO grant (2026-2028) converting a catalytic start-up initiative into a long-term programme delivering agricultural extension services through digital channels	ADVANCED
World Bank Digital ID for Inclusion Project	US\$350m approved, with no disbursement or performance rating on file	Rated Satisfactory on both development objective and implementation progress, 23% disbursed with US\$46.4m disbursed since the start of the 2026 financial year, and about 190,000 refugee registrations against 170,000 identity issuances	ADVANCED

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Federal appropriation for digital transformation	ETB 3.75bn appropriated for FY2025/26	ETB 9.05bn for FY2026/27, dominated by the AI university line	ADVANCED, MOSTLY THE BIRR FLOAT RATHER THAN REAL GROWTH
Published budget execution for FY2025/26	None published	H1 FY2025/26: ETB 704.7bn mobilised, 48.1% of the annual target, against ETB 798.2bn spent, 48.3% of the approved budget	ADVANCED

The federal digital appropriation held position as a system while its numbers moved a great deal — ETB 1.21bn to 3.75bn to 9.05bn across three fiscal years. The mechanism is unchanged and most of the rise is the birr float.

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Third mobile network operator licence	An Ethiopian Communications Authority licensing round, tender or ministerial decision on a third full operator licence.	2026-08-04
Secondary directives under the data-protection law	Directives issued by the Ethiopian Communications Authority under Proclamation 1321/2024, or a first enforcement action taken under it.	2026-08-04
Gulf digital cooperation	An MoU, investment or ministerial readout naming a Gulf state counterparty in Ethiopian digital infrastructure, AI or payments.	2026-08-04
Audit of digital spending for any in-scope year	An Office of the Federal Auditor General report for EFY 2017 or later; its published library stops at EFY 2016.	2026-08-04
Independent data-protection safeguards over the national digital identity	a published data-protection impact assessment for the national digital identity, a statutory limit on state access to its data, or a redress mechanism a registrant could use	2026-08-09

Seven subjects carry no reliable position at either end, all probed once on 2026-08-04. Five returned a named document. The telecom licensing directive, the Ministry of Finance mid-year review for 2025/26, the Auditor General's report for EFY 2017, and an account of the capital city's one-stop platform are all now acquisition lines.

Ethiopia's subnational digital tier — eleven service centres and more than 150 services in Addis Ababa alone, with online services also reported in three other cities — is entirely absent from the base.

Two absences stand dated: no licensing framework for low-earth-orbit satellite operators, and no Ethiopia-specific Gulf digital instrument.

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